

Lab: Build a Verified Finance Review Pack

Build time: 40 minutes **Peer review:** 10 minutes **Files:** Northstar_Life_Monthly_Performance.xlsx, Northstar_Monthly_Review_Notes.docx, Finance_Claim_Ledger.xlsx, Northstar_Finance_Fallback_Outputs.pdf

Access check

1. Open the workbook in the approved Excel desktop or web surface available in your tenant.
2. Open Instructions, then select PerformanceData and confirm the table name is PerformanceData.
3. Confirm Variance, VariancePct, and Favorability contain calculated values. Open MonthlyContext and confirm loss-ratio values appear.
4. Use the approved Copilot entry point available in your tenant. If it cannot use the workbook directly, move to the paired or observe route rather than uploading the file elsewhere.
5. Locate the fallback PDF before starting.

CREATE

Paste:

Using PerformanceData, rank the five largest unfavorable variances by absolute dollars. Revenue below plan and Claims or Expense above plan are unfavorable. Show amount, percentage, month, and category. Do not infer causes.

Then paste:

For each finding, cite the exact row or formula and flag any data-quality issue that could change the result.

Checkpoint: June Paid Claims should be independently recalculated as **\$858,000 – \$790,000 = \$68,000 unfavorable (8.6%)**.

REFINE

Paste:

Reframe the analysis for a finance director. Lead with the three material findings, quantify each, and separate supported explanations from hypotheses.

Open the review notes, then paste:

After opening the review notes, state which hypotheses the notes support, contradict, or leave unresolved. Do not upgrade a hypothesis to fact without direct evidence.

VERIFY CLAIMS

1. Copy at least three material claims into the Claim Ledger.
2. For each, record source, calculation/check, status, uncertainty, and owner.
3. Independently recalculate the largest unfavorable dollar variance.
4. Paste:

Create a claim-verification ledger with columns: claim, source, calculation/check, status, uncertainty, owner. Include only material findings.

5. Paste:

For each claim, explain what evidence would contradict it or lower confidence.

PREPARE TO PRESENT

Paste:

Using only claims marked Verified or Supported in the attached ledger, draft a one-page finance director brief: headline, three material findings, risks, open questions, and decisions needed.

Then paste:

Audit the draft against the ledger. Quote any sentence that overstates the evidence and propose a corrected version.

Done when

- Three findings are ranked by unfavorable **absolute dollars** and quantified.
- At least three ledger rows show source, check, status, uncertainty, and owner.
- One material claim is independently recalculated.
- The one-page brief separates facts, supported explanations, hypotheses, open questions, and decisions.

If behind: complete CREATE, verify June Paid Claims, fill one ledger row, and draft a two-sentence headline plus open question.

Stretch: compare the dollar ranking with percentage ranking. Explain why management priority could differ and which basis you would use for a specific decision.

Peer review (10 minutes)

Check one number, challenge one explanation, and correct one sentence before the debrief.